

COMMON WAYS PEOPLE LEAK INFORMATION



1

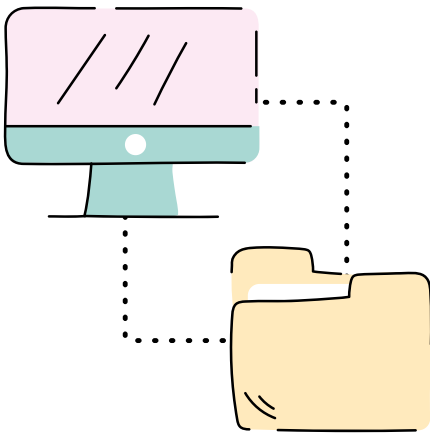
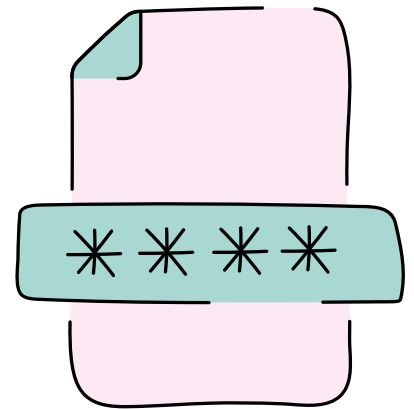
PUBLIC WI-FI

Open networks in cafes, airports and hotels rarely use strong encryption. Attackers take advantage of this and intercept unprotected data. (NortonLifeLock, 2023).

2

AUTO-CONNECT SETTINGS

Many phones and laptops will automatically join networks they've used before or that have similar names. Attackers will set up a "Evil Twin" hotspot that mimics networks to trick you or your device in joining theirs.(CISA, 2023).



3

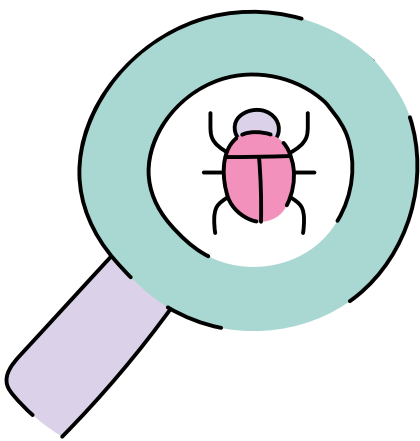
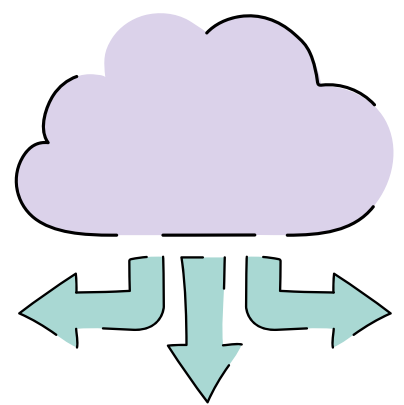
FILE AND PRINTER SHARING

Features that are meant for convenience at home or work can often expose private folders or documents when left on in public. Attackers on the same network can access these shared files without needing your permission (FTC, 2023).

4

OUTDATED SECURITY PROTOCOLS

Older Wi-Fi standards like WEP and WPA are still in use and can be cracked easily today. Modern routers need to use WPA3 or at least WPA2-AES to ensure protection (NIST, 2020).



5

OVERSHARING ON SOCIAL MEDIA

Interesting enough posting information such as location, travel plans or photos of sensitive spaces can give cyber criminals clues for social engineering or password recovery attacks (FTC, 2023). (For all you people who's password is their pet.)

**Think and treat public Wi-Fi's like a open
airspace.
That anyone can listen in.**

HOW HACKERS EXPLOIT THESE WEAKNESSES



1

EVIL TWIN HOTSPOTS

Attackers create fake Wi-Fi access points that will mimic trusted network names. When someone connects, attackers can intercept login data or redirect traffic through their own systems (CISA, 2023).



MAN-IN-THE-MIDDLE ATTACKS

2

Attackers will position themselves between your device and the network's router capturing all transmitted data. This will allow them to read messages, alter transactions or inject malicious content (NIST, 2020).



3

PACKET SNIFFING

Specialized tools can monitor unencrypted Wi-Fi networks and record data packets as they move across the network. Then they can analyze these packets to recover usernames, cookies or session tokens that will grant access to your accounts (NortonLifeLock, 2023).



CREDENTIAL THEFT

4

Once they have acquired your usernames and password they will then test them on other services. Because most people reuse passwords so once a stolen login is acquired it can usually unlock multiple accounts.



ALL YOUR BASE ARE TO
BELONG TO US





How to Protect Yourself

Security works best in layers so combining these gives stronger protection.

01	WPA3 or Trusted Networks Only
02	Turn off Auto-Connect and Sharing when not in use.
03	Use a VPN always and especially on public Wi-Fi to encrypt your activity.
04	Verify the Network Name before connecting to it.
05	Avoid using Sensitive Login Information while on open Wi-Fi.
06	Use Strong and Unique passwords with use of multi-factor authentication

Awareness is the first step toward **protecting yourself** from cyber threats and vulnerabilities online.

As our reliance on technology increases, so does the necessity for vigilance against cyber threats and personal data leaks.

60%

of people have used public Wi-Fi to log into their personal email accounts (NortonLifeLock, 2023).

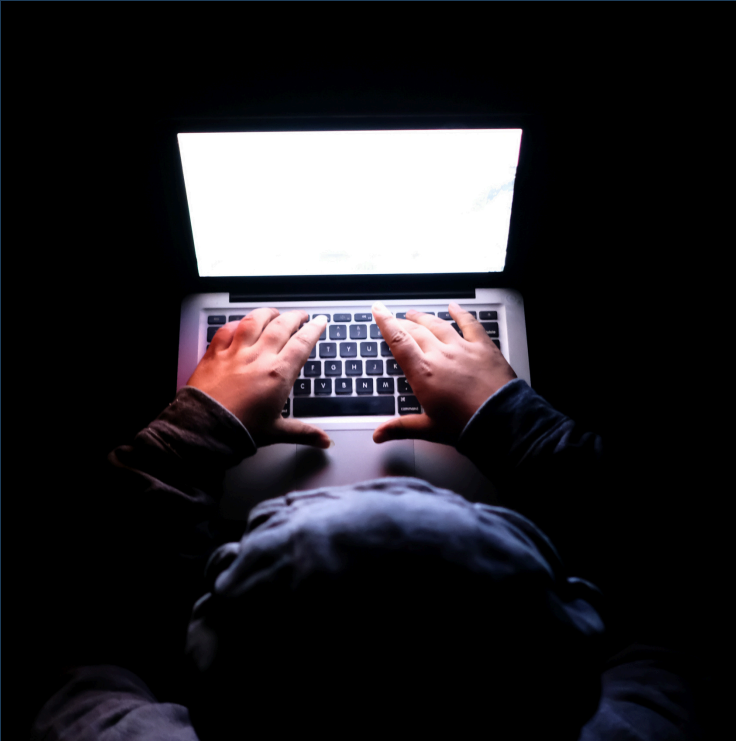
45%

of people believe public Wi-Fi is “mostly safe” (CISA, 2023).

25%

of people have logged into banking apps over public Wi-Fi (FTC, 2023).

Awareness isn’t just an individual effort its a collective one. The more people that understand these risk the more secure our networks will become. SPREAD THE WORD!



Attackers can clone a Wi-Fi hotspot in under 2 minutes! (NIST, 2020).

References

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